STATE OF WASHINGTON
DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL AND HEALTH SERVICES
COMMUNITY SERVICES DIVISION
Economic Services Administration
Post Office Box 45440 Olympia WA 98504-5440

Aug. 6, 2024

Dear interested parties and community partners,

As you are aware, we are in fire season in Washington. I wanted to be certain you are aware households that suffer a loss of food purchased with food benefits due to a household disaster or misfortune can contact the department for replacement of the loss, for up to one month's benefits. A household misfortune or disaster could be a fire, flood, Public Safety Power Shutoff or other power outage lasting four or more hours.

How to claim a loss

Households may report the loss of food purchased with food benefits, due to a household disaster or misfortune, verbally or in writing. The report must be made within 10 days of the loss. Additionally, federal rules and WAC 388-412-0040 require a signed statement that attests to the loss must be received from the household within 10 days of the date the loss was reported. Benefits cannot be replaced prior to timely receipt of the signed statement.

The signed statement must include all of the following:

- The head of household's signature
- The date(s) the food purchased with Basic Food benefits was destroyed
- The value of food lost in the disaster (purchased with food benefits)
- The cause of loss or misfortune (e.g., a power outage for six hours)

The statement could be a letter about the loss, a completed DSHS 12-008 *DSHS Claim of Food Lost in a Household Disaster* or by attestation to the loss with a telephonic signature. Staff will request additional details as needed to validate the claim, such as the power company and time of the outage, before processing the claim.

Please feel free to share this information with households that may be affected by this sort of loss.

Sincerely,

Brice Montgomery, Interim Director
Community Services Division

DSHS: *Transforming Lives*